

with technology. From oral traditions to books, from cinema to OTT, each medium allowed stories to reach people in deeper ways. Gaming is the next natural step. It is immersive, participatory, and emotionally powerful. For Indian epics especially, which are not passive tales but moral journeys, gaming offers something unique. It allows the player to live the story, make choices, and experience dharma rather than just read about it. That potential inspired me to step into this space. Plus, my son loves video games, and I thought it was a good way to be a cool dad!

The Age of Bhaarat is being touted as one of India's first AAA action-adventure games set in ancient India. What kind of world and experience can players expect?

Amish: Players can expect a richly imagined world rooted in ancient Indian civilization but presented with modern production values. It is not a history lesson, nor is it legends retold verbatim. It is a living, breathing world inspired by our epics, forests, philosophies, conflicts, and moral dilemmas. The experience blends action, exploration, and story, where the player is not just fighting enemies but navigating choices that reflect deeper values.

Developing a high-end game isn't easy, especially in India. What challenges have you and the team faced?

Amish: We at Tara gaming have put together a fantastic team of industry experts like the gaming veteran Nour-dine Abboud working on the game. There are challenges in building a AAA-quality game in India right now as it requires capital, time, and global standards of execution. India is still building that ecosystem. However, we also have enormous strengths. We have world-class creative talent, engineers, artists, and storytellers. Eventually, it is about patience, collaboration, and believing that India can build at global scale if we commit fully to it.

In terms of storytelling, how are you ensuring authenticity to Indian ethos while appealing to a global audience?

Amish: Authenticity does not mean complexity or exclusion. The Indian ethos is universal at its core. Concepts like duty, sacrifice, loyalty, greed, and courage are understood everywhere. We focus on emotional truth rather than cultural exposition. The world Age of Bhaarat is Indian, the soul is universal. If the story is honest and the characters are compelling, global audiences connect naturally as they have done with so many other games from various cultures.

How do you think a successful game like The Age of Bhaarat could impact Indian gaming?

Amish: Success would signal possibility. It would tell creators, investors, and young talent that Indian studios can build global-quality IP rooted in Indian stories. It could catalyse confidence, funding, and ambition across the industry. Every creative ecosystem needs a few bold first movers. If we can contribute to that shift, it would be deeply fulfilling.

With your background in literature, do you see potential for more cross-overs between Indian novels, mythology, and video games?

Amish: Very much so. India has one of the richest reservoirs of stories in the world. For too long, we have limited these stories to books and television. Gaming allows an immersive experience, expansion of the target market, and reinvention of our cultural industry. I believe we are only at the beginning of this movement, and it will grow rapidly over the next decade.

Can interactive storytelling influence our youth's deeper connection to Indian culture and history?

Amish: Yes, and importantly, it can

do so without preaching. Games allow curiosity that leads to learning. When young players explore worlds inspired by Indian culture through play, they build an emotional relationship with it. That connection is far more powerful than instruction. It makes culture feel alive and relevant.

As someone entering the gaming ecosystem, what are your predictions for Indian gaming through 2026 and 2027?

Amish: India will move from being a consumption market to a creation market. Mobile gaming will continue to grow, but we will also see more ambition in PC and console titles. Original Indian IP's will begin to find



global audiences. My vision is for Indian gaming to stand confidently alongside global studios, not as an exception, but as a norm. We have great stories, we have talent, and the will to create.

What is your message to young Indians or concerned parents about pursuing a career in gaming?

Amish: Gaming may seem like play, but it is not merely that. It is a confluence of technology, art, storytelling, music, design, and business. It demands discipline, skill, and creativity. For parents, I would say this is a serious industry with long-term potential. For young people, I would say pursue it with passion and professionalism. India needs builders in this space, not just players, and the best part is that we have it all. **■**